

# Acassist — Pre-Build Checklist

*Two days before the build · Thursday Oct 1 & Friday Oct 2 · Build day: Saturday, Oct 3, 2026 (~12-hour single block)*

The theme of these two days is **coordination and rest, not code**. The plan is locked. The win now is walking into the room aligned and sharp. Everything here is planning — the moment anyone writes the Rust hasher, the JS renderer, or a Groq call, that's the build, and the build is Saturday.

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## Thursday, Oct 1 — lock the logistics

- [ ] **Confirm the exact 12-hour window** — real start and freeze times from the organizers. The whole schedule is "fractions of the window"; you can't pace without the actual clock.
- [ ] **Confirm the four lanes out loud with the team**: technical lead = Rust scoring core; exec lead = AI content generation; UI dev = quiz-take UI + lesson render + shell; demo/submission owner = demo, video, repo.
- [ ] **Confirm the Amazon Quick proof format with organizers** — screenshot? in the repo? a form field? Satisfies the required-tech rule and dodges the 5-point-per-platform penalty, but only if captured in the format they want.
- [ ] **Confirm Kiro is set up** on every builder's machine — it's the spec-driven dev environment, so a broken install at hour zero is a real cost.

## Friday, Oct 2 — align, prep, then stop

- [ ] **Circulate the team build sheet** — get the Rust dev and UI dev to both read the **JSON contract + normalization rule**. Highest-leverage item on the list: it's what stops the two lanes from drifting and handing you a "correct answer marked wrong" bug at 3am.
- [ ] **Agree the normalization rule concretely** — lowercase | trim | strip\_punctuation, mirrored exactly on both sides. Decide edge cases now (what counts as punctuation? Unicode?) so no one improvises Saturday.
- [ ] **Sketch the demo script on paper** — the wifi-off moment is the whole game: load module -> wifi off -> take quiz -> scored on-device -> score shown. Know who drives, who talks.
- [ ] **Assign the pre-generated fallback module** — someone owns having a known-good JSON module ready so a failed live Groq call never breaks the demo.
- [ ] **REST**. On the list deliberately. A sharp team at hour 8 beats an exhausted one that over-prepared. Don't start "just stubbing" the core Friday night — the build is a team event; starting solo throws away the point of the locked room.

## The line

Everything above is **planning and coordination** — allowed and smart. Building anything that reads or writes the module JSON is Saturday. Spec on paper, code in the room.